

Administrative Writing, Intermediate

This textbook helps you build practical administrative writing skills step by step. You begin with the basics of clear sentences, professional tone, and paragraph structure. Then you move into common workplace writing tasks such as emails, clarification requests, delay updates, procedures, notices, summaries, and short explanations. In the later units, you combine these skills across multiple documents, revise earlier writing more carefully, and prepare a small portfolio of stronger final work.

The book is designed for intermediate-level learners who need English for real office communication. The goal is not to make your writing sound overly formal or complicated. The goal is to help you write messages that are clear, polite, well organised, and useful for the reader. Throughout the book, you will compare weaker and stronger examples, study useful language, practise writing with support, and then write more independently.

The book also teaches different kinds of workplace messages, not only external emails. You will practise internal messages for colleagues, short notices for teams, meeting summaries, problem explanations, procedures, clarification requests, correction messages, and sets of related documents written for different readers. Some tasks ask you to write to an outside office or applicant, while others ask you to explain the same situation inside your own team. This helps you understand how audience,

purpose, tone, and level of detail change from one document type to another.

Each unit follows a clear learning sequence. First, you notice a writing problem or compare two versions. Next, you study the language, structure, or pattern that makes the stronger version work. After that, you practise the skill in guided and freer tasks, edit weak writing, and check your own progress. This repeated pattern helps you build control little by little instead of trying to write everything perfectly at once.

By the end of the book, you should be able to write short administrative texts with better control of accuracy, tone, clarity, and organisation. You should also be better able to adapt one situation for different readers, revise your own drafts, and choose language that helps the reader understand what happened, what is needed, and what should happen next.

OVERVIEW

MODULE 1 gives you the basic writing skills you need for the rest of the book.

Unit 1: Clear Sentence Structure teaches you how to compare sentences, study sentence patterns, build a short message, and fix reader problems caused by weak sentence control.

Unit 2: Professional Tone Basics teaches you how to compare tone, use polite request phrases, write a more professional email, and remove tone problems from weak writing.

Unit 3: Paragraph Structure teaches you how to compare paragraphs, study paragraph structure, build one paragraph from facts, and repair paragraph logic so your writing stays focused.

MODULE 2 focuses on short professional emails.

Unit 4: Email Layout and Standard Phrases teaches you how to identify clear email organisation, use standard email parts, and repair weak email structure.

Unit 5: Requesting Clarification teaches you how to ask clear questions, use clarification phrases, and write messages that help the reader answer easily.

Unit 6: Communicating Delays or Changes teaches you how to explain delays or changes clearly, include missing information, and reduce reader uncertainty.

Unit 7: Making Requests Politely teaches you how to choose polite request forms, write useful request emails, and vary politeness for different situations.

MODULE 3 moves into common internal communication tasks.

Unit 8: Writing Simple Procedures teaches you how to analyse a procedure model, use instruction verbs, complete missing steps, and write a clear workplace procedure.

Unit 9: Internal Notices teaches you how to identify a useful notice, study notice basics, write internal notices, and repair weak notice writing.

Unit 10: Explaining Problems Clearly teaches you how to include missing details, use problem explanation phrases, and write explanations that help the reader understand the situation.

Unit 11: Writing Simple Meeting Summaries teaches you how to compare summaries, study summary elements, write short summaries, and improve weak summary writing.

MODULE 4 develops writing for outside communication and clearer explanation.

Unit 12: Writing Simple External Inquiries teaches you how to study inquiry structure, write inquiry emails, and repair weak inquiry writing.

Unit 13: Providing Simple Explanations teaches you how to use explanation phrases, write clear explanations, and adapt your explanation for different readers.

Unit 14: Responding to Confusion teaches you how to identify the point of confusion, write a clarification response, and remove defensive tone.

Unit 15: Maintaining Consistent Email Style teaches you how to spot inconsistencies, study standard email elements, and make related emails follow one clear professional style.

MODULE 5 focuses on editing and revision skills.

Unit 16: Editing for Accuracy teaches you how to spot errors, compare edited versions, edit short texts, and explain why a correction is needed.

Unit 17: Editing for Clarity teaches you how to find unclear sentences, compare clearer versions, and improve vague writing.

Unit 18: Editing for Tone teaches you how to identify tone problems, compare improved versions, and adjust tone for different readers while keeping the message useful.

MODULE 6 brings the earlier skills together in larger final tasks.

Unit 19: Integrated Task 1: Combined Email + Internal Explanation teaches you how to write from one shared situation for two readers with different needs.

Unit 20: Integrated Task 2: Revision + Notice Writing teaches you how to manage a correction situation across a revision message and a notice.

Unit 21: Writing for Consistency Across a Team teaches you how to identify team consistency problems, standardise short messages, and turn rewrites into shared rules.

Unit 22: Multi-Document Communication Task teaches you how to write for three readers and keep each document suited to its audience.

Unit 23: Portfolio Writing & Final Revision teaches you how to revise a guided set of work, rebuild a weaker piece, and assemble a final portfolio of stronger writing.

SECTION GUIDE

The book uses the same section pattern in each unit because a clear learning sequence makes new writing skills easier to understand and practise. Recognise each stage of the lesson, focus on the writing itself and build the target skill step by step and with less confusion.

- A. **Warm-Up** helps you start the unit. It introduces the topic, connects it to real work, and helps you notice the main writing problem before the lesson begins.
- B. **Example Check** shows you a model or a pair of examples. This section helps you compare versions, notice important features, and see why one piece of writing works better.
- C. **Language** teaches the language or writing pattern for the unit. You study useful phrases, short examples, or controlled tasks so you can prepare for the writing work that comes next.
- D. **Guided Practice** gives you supported writing practice. You may use a model, a template, supplied content, or a short scenario so the writing task feels clear and manageable.
- E. **Freer Practice** gives you a more independent writing task. You still use the same target skill, but with less support, so you can show that you can use it in a realistic situation.
- F. **Editing Practice** helps you improve writing by checking and revising it. You may correct problems, rewrite weak parts, or review a draft more carefully.
- G. **Self-Check and Reflection** helps you look back at your work. You check what you can do now, notice what still feels difficult, and think about how the skill connects to your real workplace writing.
- H. **Homework & Extension** helps you transfer the unit skill to another task. It may ask you to continue the same kind of writing at home or use the skill in a more real-world situation.

ACTIVITY GUIDE

The book also reuses a consistent set of activity types which help you learn more efficiently. Learn what each activity type is designed to do, approach the task with a clearer focus and develop stronger control over planning, writing, checking, and revising.

- **Edit** asks you to correct or polish writing carefully. You focus on fixing problems, improving accuracy, and making the text more professional.
- **Example** shows you a model text or sample. You read it to see what the writing looks like before you analyse it, improve it, or write your own version.
- **Learn** gives you a short teaching point to read and understand. It explains an idea, a writing principle, or a useful way to approach the task.

- **Language** gives you useful words, phrases, or sentence patterns to use. It helps you build the language support you need before writing.
- **Notice** asks you to look carefully at something and spot an important feature. You may compare versions, identify a problem, or notice what makes a text work.
- **Rewrite** asks you to change given text into a better or more suitable version. You work from supplied content and transform it in a clearer or more useful way.
- **Revise** asks you to improve a draft you already wrote. You go back to earlier work and strengthen the content, structure, or tone.
- **Structure** helps you organise writing clearly. It shows parts, order, layout, or a planning frame so you can build a text in a logical way.
- **Write** asks you to produce your own text. You use the target skill more independently and create a new response for the task.